

CHAPTER ONE

Introduction to Communication & Communication in the Workplace

Books

- What Every Engineer Should Know About Business Communication by John X. Wang
- Lesikar's Business Communication connecting in a Digital World. McGraw-Hill International Edition. Business Communication By Rodney Overton
- Harvard Business Review on Communication
- Business Communication By Vikram Bisen, Priya
- Business Communication By Rodney Overton
- Entrepreneurship for Engineers (2nd Edition), Helmut Kohlert, Dawud Fadai Hans-Ul Rich Sachs.



Learning Objectives

Upon completing this chapter, you will understand the role and nature of communication in business. To achieve this goal, you should be able to

1. Explain the importance of communication to you and to business.
2. Describe the main challenges facing business communicators today.
3. Describe the three main categories of business communication.
4. Describe the formal and informal communication networks of the business organization.
5. Describe factors that affect the types and amount of communicating that a business does.
6. Explain why business communication is a form of problem solving.
7. Describe the various contexts for each act of business communication.
8. Describe the business communication process.

COMMUNICATION MATTERS

Communication is the most used skills in almost every job. How you communicate your accomplishments to others is a reflection of the quality of your work. You must know how to do your tasks to accomplish great results, but that is only a portion of professional success.

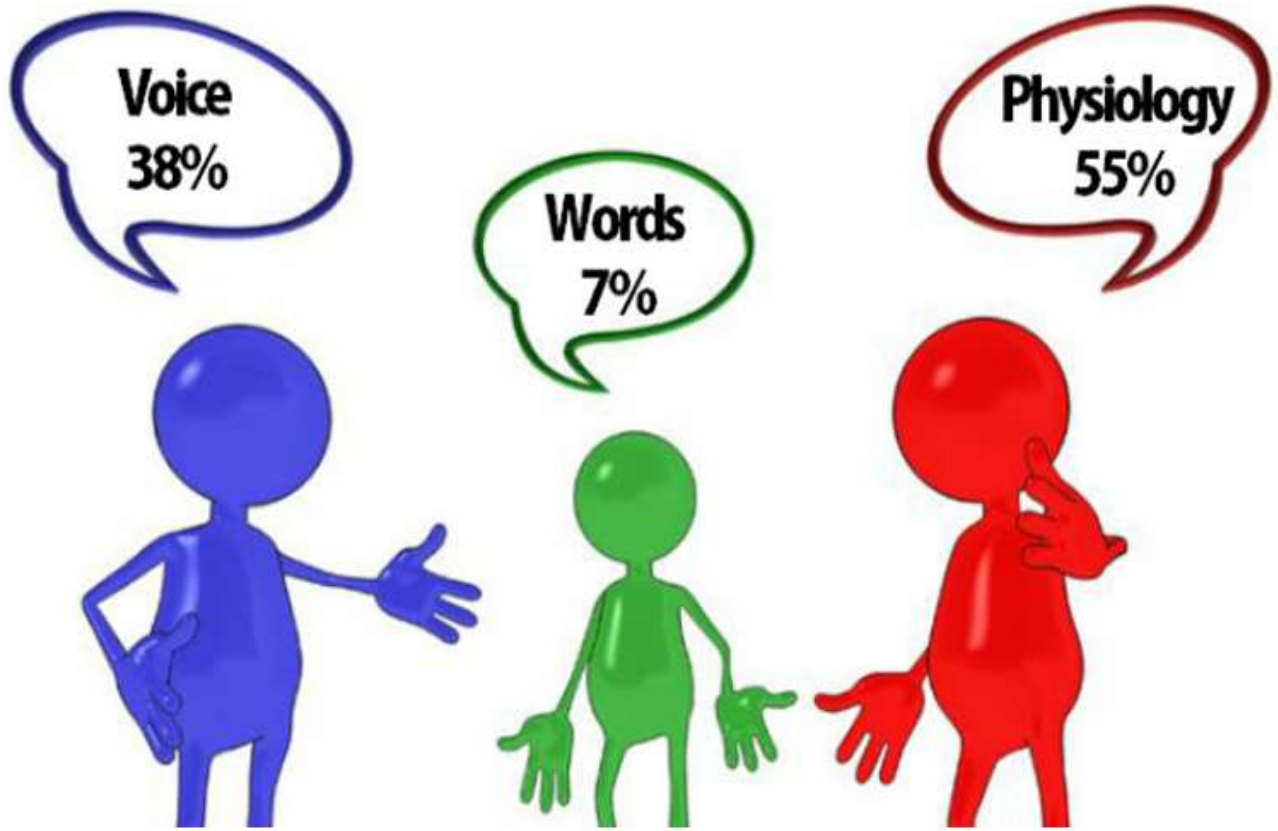
Good communication skills are required to report your results to others, persuade colleagues to talk, and (most importantly at review time) sell your successes to management----Don Zatyko, Lead Project Manager Kaiser Permanente

What is Communication?





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Facts :

- 55% perceived nonverbally.
- 7% depends on what is said.
- 38% depends on how it is said.

Communication



American Management Association, ‘any behaviour that results in an exchange of meaning’.

Peter ‘process by which information is transmitted between individuals and/or organizations so that an understanding response result’.

Keith Davis, ‘process of passing the information and understanding from one person to another. Essentially a bridge of meaning between the people & by using the bridge a person can safely across the river of misunderstanding.

Newman and Summer Jr. state that, ‘an exchange of facts, ideas, opinions or emotions by two or more persons.’

Exchange of facts, ideas, opinions and as a means that individual or organization share meaning and understanding with one another.

Business Communication



Transferring information from one part of the business to another that leads to some outcome, changed behaviour or changed practice.

- Facilitates decision-making
- Problem-solving
- Relationship Building



Role of Communication in Business

Importance of Communication skills

(Needs & Wants, Success; NFI, 431 job outlook survey; R/D/W/I; NPI-efficiency & communication; and leadership).

- Why Business (social & economic Process) depends upon communication?

Salespeople → customers, Executives → manger, Production mgt→ orders, MKT profess→ MKT, Researchers→ info, PR professionals → trust (all exchange info).

Challenges of Business Communications

1. Communication in Hybrid and Remote Work Environments

- Maintaining clarity, engagement, and collaboration when teams are dispersed across different locations and time zones.

2. Cross-Cultural and Global Communication

Managing cultural differences, language barriers, & communication styles in international business contexts.

3. Information Overload

- Employees and managers face overwhelming volumes of emails, messages, and notifications.

4. Digital Communication Etiquette

- Balancing professionalism with informality in online platforms such as WhatsApp, and social media.

5. Misinformation and Lack of Message Clarity

- Inaccurate or unclear messages lead to confusion and poor decision-making.

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6. Data Privacy and Security in Communication

- Protecting confidential information shared via email, cloud platforms, and messaging apps.

7. Emotional Intelligence and Empathy

- Building trust and understanding in virtual or high-stress business environments.

8. Adapting to Rapid Technological Change

- Keeping up with new communication tools (e.g., AI-driven chatbots, virtual reality meetings).

9. Generation Gap in Communication

- Bridging communication preferences between Baby Boomers, Gen X, Millennials, and Gen Z employees

10. Crisis and Change Communication

- Managing transparency, trust, and consistency during organizational crises or change processes.

Types of Business Communication

Operational

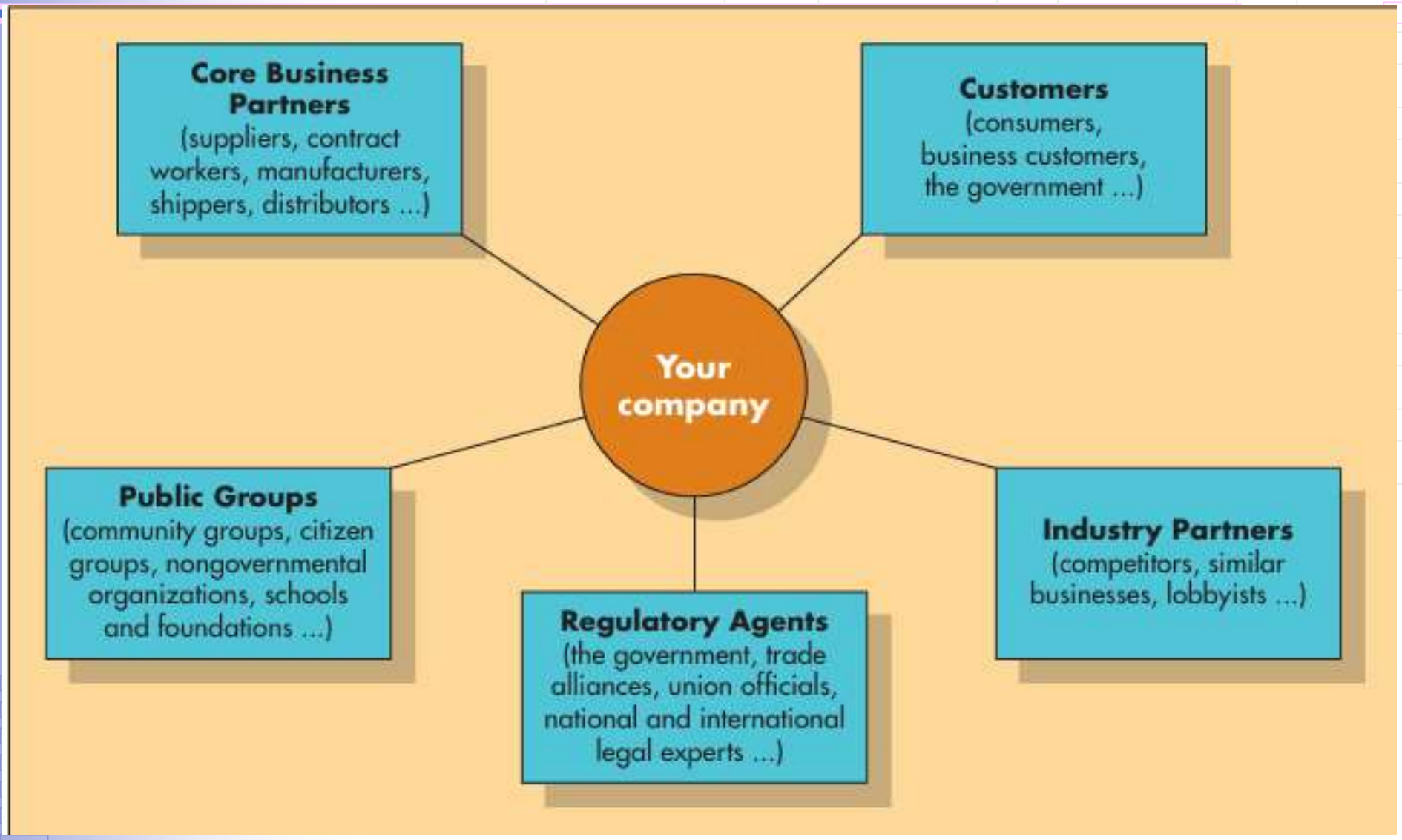
Internal
External



Personal



External Communication



Verbal Communication

- Oral communication: message or information exchanges by spoken words (face to face and mechanical devices).
- Written communication

Non-Verbal Communication

- Process of communication through sending and receiving wordless messages.
- Gesture; body language or posture; facial expression and eye contact; object communication.

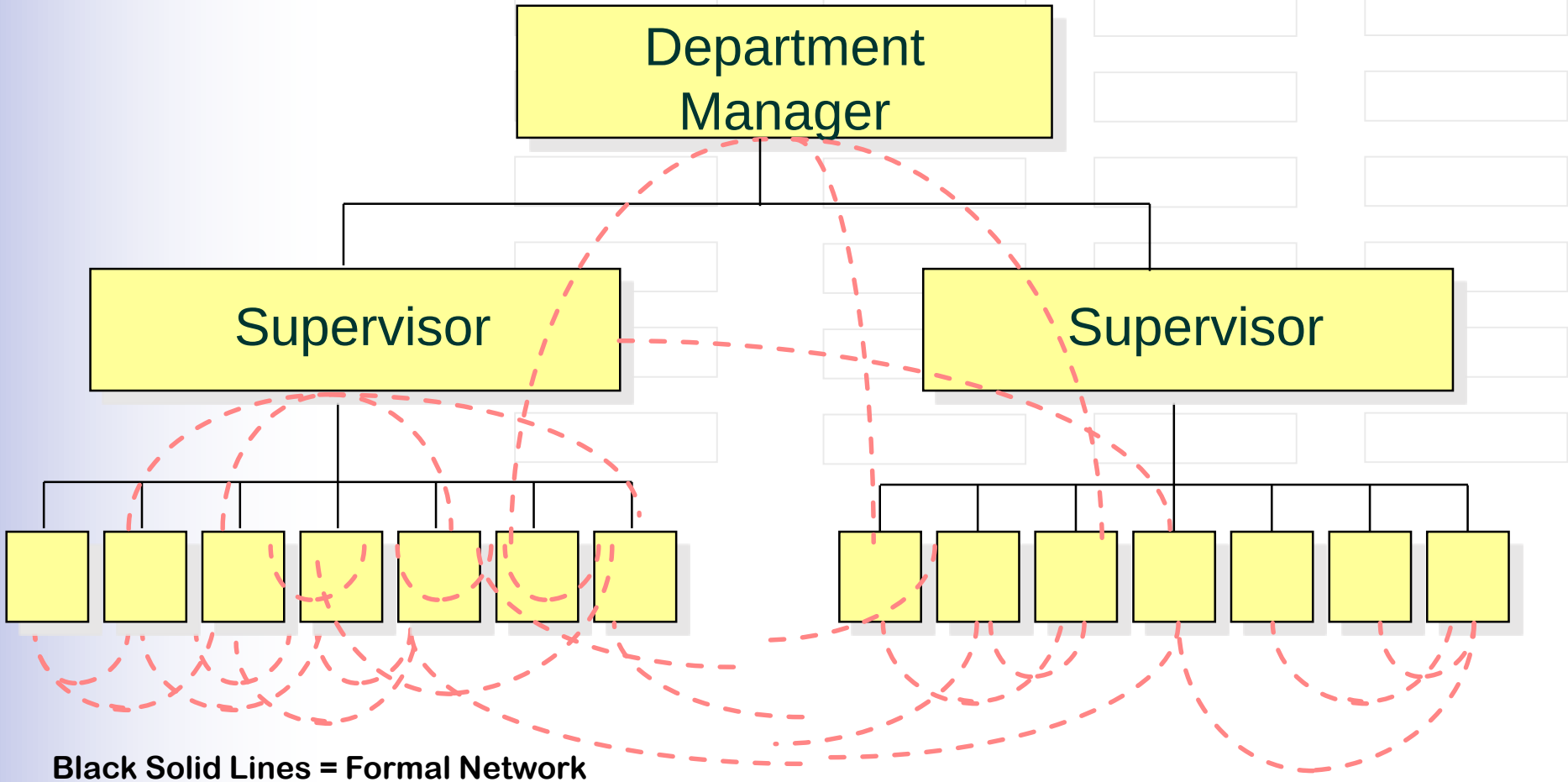
Verbal vs. non-Verbal communication

Oral Communication	Non-Verbal Communication
• Confidence • Thoroughness • Friendliness • At ease - comfortable • Approachability • The mind set of both parties • Appearance and grooming • Tone of voice • Empathy	• Body language and signals • Gestures and facial expressions • Graphics • Brochures • Overheads • Samples of products • Inspections • Videos • Photos • Demonstrations

Communication Networks

- Formal Network
  - well-established, usually along operational lines
  - planned
- Informal Network
  - complex
  - dynamic

The Formal and Informal Communication Networks in a Division of a Small Manufacturing Company



Black Solid Lines = Formal Network
Coral Dashed Lines = Informal Network (at a moment in time, for they change often)

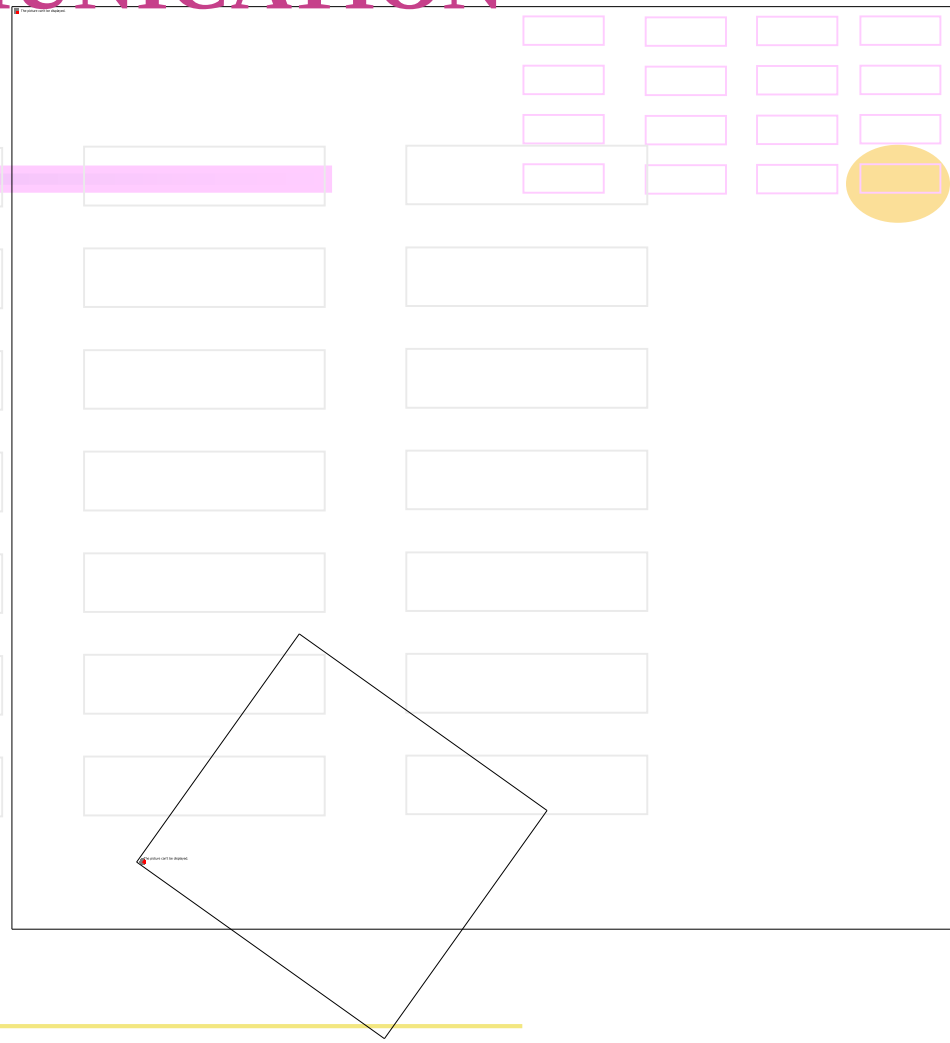
FACTORS AFFECTING COMMUNICATION

Context

Refers to the specific circumstances surrounding the communication process, including the physical setting, the relationship between the sender and receiver, and any cultural or social factors that may influence the communication.

Noise

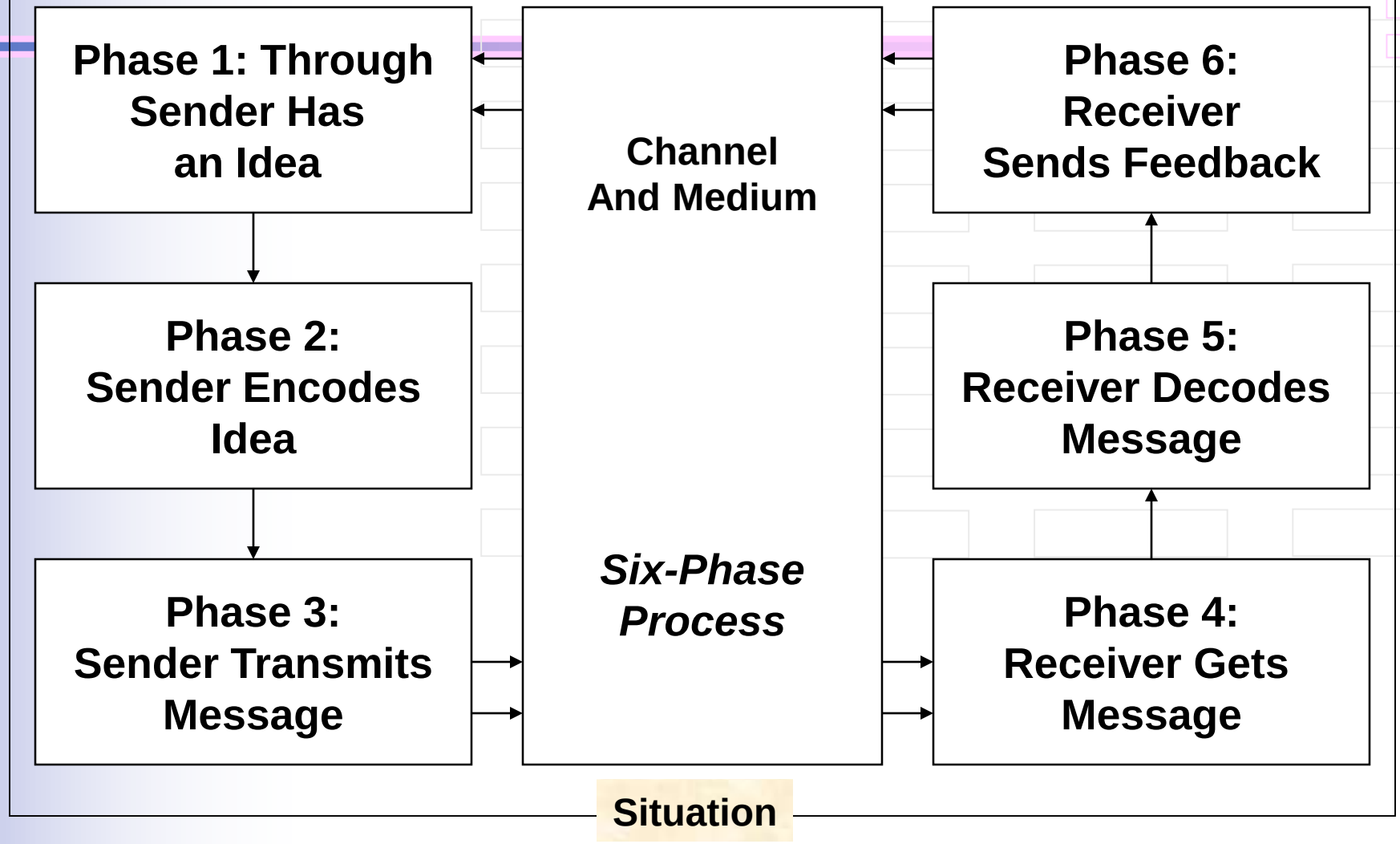
Refers to any distractions that disrupt the smooth transmission and reception common of the message.



Culture & Language

Cultural and linguistic differences can significantly influence how messages are perceived and understood. Different cultures may have unique communication norms, gestures, or customs that affect the interpretation of messages.

The Communication Process



The Communication Process

- The process of communication beings when one person (sending initiates a through. He or she may decide that the through backed by certain idea, opinion, or fact needs to be transmitted to someone else.
- The next step is to encode, the meaning into a form appropriate to the situation. This encoding might take the form of verbal words, gestures, facial expressions, physical actions or even artistic expressions.
- After encoding, the message is transmitted through the appropriate channel. The common channels include printed pages, face-to-face discussion, the air waves and telephone lines.
- The message is received and decoded by one or more other people via such senses as eyesight and hearing.
- After the message is received, it must be translated into understanding to the receiver.

The Business Communication Process

Communicator 1 …

1. senses a communication need
2. defines the problem
3. searches for possible solutions
4. selects a course of action (message type, contents, style, format, channel)
5. composes the message
6. delivers the message



Communicator 2 …

7. receives the message
8. interprets the message
9. decides on a response
10. may send a responding message

The Role of Technology in Business Communication

Email



Instant Messaging



Video Conferencing




thank you
danke
謝謝
ngiyabonga
teşekkür ederim
gracias
merci
obrigado
dziękuję
bedankt
go raibh maith agat
mochchakkeram
sukriya
kop khun krap
terima kasih
dakujem
arigatô
grazie
tapadh leat
спасибо
рахмат
Баярлалаа
dank je
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mercé
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trugarez
তোমাকে ধন্যবাদ
감사합니다
xièxie
ευχαριστώ